UNIT 5

Democracy



5.1 Definition and types of Democracy

The term 'Democracy' is derived from the Greek word as 'demo' means people and 'cracy' is referred as rule. The concept of democracy in its Greek term comes from "demos and "kratos" meaning "people" and "rule". Thus the term democracy is Rule by People.



Democracy is one of the most important and well-debated topics in the world since the beginning of the Twentieth Century and it has increased importance in the Twenty-first century. The concept and practice of Democracy in the Modern period evolved in Britain, although it's ancient concept and practice was in Ancient Greece. The spread of Democracy in began in the world in different countries from the beginning of the Twentieth-century.

Characteristics of Democracy

a) Democracy rests upon the principles of majority rule, along with individual and minority rights.

b) The right of the people to demand the Government they elected and the duty of the Government to be accessible and responsive to their needs and demands is the main function.

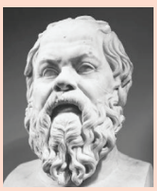
c) One of the primary functions of Democracies is to protect such basic Human Rights i) Equality before Law, ii) Equal Protection before Law iii) Freedom of Speech, iv) Freedom of Religion; v) Right to organize and participate fully in the political, economic, and cultural life of society.



d) Democracies conduct regular free and fair elections open to all citizens.

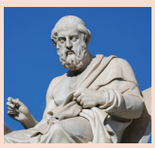
e) Democracy ensures that all citizens receive equal protection under the law and that their rights are protected by the Legal-constitutional system.

Democracy defined by Philosophers:



"Democracy would, it seems, a delightful form of government, anarchic and mostly, assigning a kind of equality indiscriminately to equals and unequals alike." ***- Socrates***

"Freedom in a democracy is the glory of the state, and therefore,in a democracy only will the freedom of nature design to dwell."



- Plato

"The foundation of democratic constitution is liberty. People constantly make this statement implying that only in this constitution is there any share in liberty at all".



- Aristotle

11th Std Political Science Eng Medium Vol-1 Page 112-142 Chapter 5.indd 65 07/12/2022 10:57:31